

17 May 78

FBI WASH DC

21

PUNISHING WHOSE THE COULD LEAD TO SUSPENSION OF ELECTIONS

FY161828Y Santiago Chile Domestic Service in Spanish 1730 GMT 16 May 78 FY

[Text] Bolivian President Hugo Banzer has said that the forthcoming elections of 2 July may be suspended if political and electoral violence increases. He said that the government is doing everything to guarantee the tranquility of the country. These remarks were made by the Bolivian president during a program over the state-owned television network. Banzer has been in power 7 years and hopes to hand over the government to the candidate who wins the elections on 2 July. The Bolivian president also publicly stated his support for the official candidate, Gen Juan Pereda Asbun.

REPORTS CONFLICT ON DETAILS OF FALLEN OBJECT

FY161931Y Sucre Radio La Plata in Spanish 1630 GMT 16 May 78 FY

[Summary] We have received another phone call from our audience requesting confirmation of reports that an unidentified object fell in Bolivian territory near the Argentine border. We can only say that Argentine and Uruguayan radio stations are reporting on this even more frequently, saying that Bolivian authorities have urgently requested assistance from the U.S. National Aeronautics and Space Administration in order to determine the nature of that which crashed on a hill in Bolivian territory. Just a few minutes ago Radio El Espectador of Montevideo announced that there was uncertainty as to the truth of these reports.

Argentine sources indicated that the border with Bolivia had been closed but that it might soon be reopened. They also reported that an unidentified object had fallen on Bolivian soil near the Argentine border and that local Bolivian authorities had requested aid from the central government which, in turn, had sought assistance from the U.S. National Aeronautics and Space Administration to investigate the case.

A La Paz newspaper said today that there is great interest in learning about the nature of the fallen object, adding that local authorities for security reasons had cordoned off 200 km around the spot where the object fell. The object is said to be a mechanical device with a diameter of almost (14 meters) which has already been brought to Tarija. There is interest in determining the accuracy of these reports which have spread quickly throughout the continent, particularly in Bolivia and its neighboring countries. Is it a satellite, a meteorite or a false alarm?

ELECTORAL COURT WILL NOT SUBMIT TO FSB PRESSURES

FY151711Y La Paz PRESENCIA in Spanish 10 May 78 p 11 FY

[Text] Responding to a declaration issued by the national assembly of the Bolivian Socialist Falcange [FSB] recently held in Cochabamba, members of the National Electoral Court have stated that "they have always been willing to resign their posts."

They warned, however, that they will definitely not submit to "pressures from political parties" and they added that "they have the sense of dignity and will preserve their dignity as the proper title and that they are not mere selfishness."

Approved for Release
Date 25 MAR 1980